GRADE 8 · TERM 1 · LESSON 1

WHO AM I?

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

- Explain what identity means.
- Identify parts of who you are.
- Begin thinking about your money story.

KEY VOCABULARY

Term	Definition	isiZulu	Afrikaans
Identity	Who you are — your beliefs, values, experiences, and how you see yourself	Ubuyena	Identiteit
Belief	Something you accept as true without always questioning it	Inkolelo	Oortuiging
Value	What matters to you; what you consider important	Okubalulekile	Waarde

MYAH'S MORNING

Myah wakes to the sound of her mother's voice.

"Vuka! Get up! Taxi does not wait."

She rubs her eyes and sees her mother at the kitchen table, counting coins. R5, R2, R1, 50c. She pushes the pile toward Myah.

"For school. Do not lose it."

Myah puts the coins in her pocket. She feels their weight all the way to the taxi rank. She does not ask where the money came from. She does not ask if there is enough. She does not ask what her mother gives up so she can get to school.

But she notices.

She notices her mother's hands — rough from work, careful with every coin. She notices the way her mother pauses before pushing the pile toward her, as if calculating what will be left for bread, for electricity, for the other things that money must do.

She does not speak her questions out loud. Not yet. But she writes them in a small notebook she keeps in her pocket.

Where does the money come from? What does Mama give up? Why do some people have more coins than others?

She does not know it yet, but these questions are the beginning of everything.

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THINKING EQUATION

Identity = Beliefs + Habits + Environment

This is your first Thinking Equation. Do not memorize it. Do not highlight it. Let it sit with you. It will return in later lessons, in later grades, in moments you cannot yet see. Its job is not to be remembered. Its job is to be recognized when life proves it true.

REFLECT

Pause and Reflect

Myah has questions she has never asked out loud. Questions about money, about her family, about herself.

What do you wonder about?

An isolated explanation for print and recovery. An isolated explanation for print and recovery. An isolated explanation for print and recovery.

Take one minute. Write down three questions about money that you have never asked out loud.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WHO ARE YOU?

If someone asked you "Who are you?" right now, what would you say?

Most people start with:

- Their name
- Their age
- Where they live
- Their family

But you are more than that. You are also:

- What you believe
- What you value
- What you are afraid of
- What you dream about
- What you have experienced
- How you see yourself

All of this is your identity.

IDENTITY AND MONEY

How you see yourself affects how you handle money.

Lerato believes she is clever with money. Her grandmother taught her to save. She feels confident when she has coins in her tin.

Sipho believes he is "bad with money." His older brother always laughs at how he spends. He feels anxious whenever he has to pay for something.

Same age. Same neighbourhood. Different identities. Different futures with money.

That is why we start here — with you.

REFLECT

Pause and Reflect

How do you see yourself with money? Confident? Anxious? Curious? Avoidant? Where did that feeling come from?

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ACTIVITY

Activity 1: My Identity Map — With Gap Analysis

Part A: Draw Your Map

Draw yourself in the centre. Around you, draw circles for:

- Family
- Friends
- School
- Things I believe
- Things I value
- Things I am good at
- Things I wonder about

Fill each circle with words or small drawings.

Part B: The Gap Analysis

Now, draw a smaller version of yourself in the corner of the page. This is your "Future Self" — the person you want to become by the end of this term.

Draw arrows from your current circles to your Future Self. Which circles need to grow? Which circles might need to shrink? Which circles are missing entirely?

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Part C: The One Action

Look at your Gap Analysis. Choose ONE circle that needs to grow the most.

The circle I will grow: —

One specific action I will take this week to grow it: —

When exactly I will do it (day and time): —

How I will know if I did it (evidence I can see): —

Portfolio evidence

ACTIVITY

Activity 2: Two Truths, One Wish, and an Audit

Complete these sentences:

One truth about me and money: When I have money, I usually —

Another truth about me and money: I learned about money from —

One wish I have about money: I wish I knew how to —

The Audit: Look at your two truths. One is probably serving you. The other might be holding you back. Circle the one that might be holding you back.

The belief that might be holding me back: —

Where this belief came from (a person, an experience, something I observed):

—

Portfolio evidence

Deepening Insight
TAP TO EXPLORE THE DEEPER IDEA

CHECKPOINT

Checkpoint (Analyze)

Look at your Identity Map and Gap Analysis from Activity 1.

QUESTION 1

PART 1 OF 2

Which circle is fullest?

—

PART 2 OF 2

Which circle is emptiest?

—

QUESTION 2

PART 1 OF 2

The fullest circle — did YOU fill it, or did someone else fill it for you?

—

PART 2 OF 2

Did you choose those beliefs, skills, and values, or did you absorb them from your environment?

—

QUESTION 3

The emptiest circle — what is the real reason it is empty?

Is it because you lack interest? Or because you have never had the opportunity, the resource, or the permission to fill it?

—

QUESTION 4

What is ONE action you will take this week to begin filling the emptiest circle — using only resources you already have?

Be specific. "I will try harder" is not an action. "I will ask my grandmother one question about how she saves money on Saturday morning" is an action.

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My one action: —

TRY THIS AT HOME

Behavioral Experiment

This week, conduct one small experiment to test how your identity shows up in real life.

The Experiment: Ask ONE person who knows you well — a family member, a friend, a neighbour — this question: "When you think about me and money, what is the first word that comes to your mind?"

Do not explain. Do not defend. Do not argue. Just listen. Write down their exact word.

The word they said: —

Does this word match how I see myself? —

If it does not match — what does the gap between their word and my word tell me?

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▸ **If the main task is not possible**

LESSON NOTES

Anything you want to remember

Your responses are captured beside each activity, reflection, table and workbook field. Use this separate space only for extra notes you want to keep about the lesson.

Synthetic follow-up note. END OF LESSON NOTE